Gmail

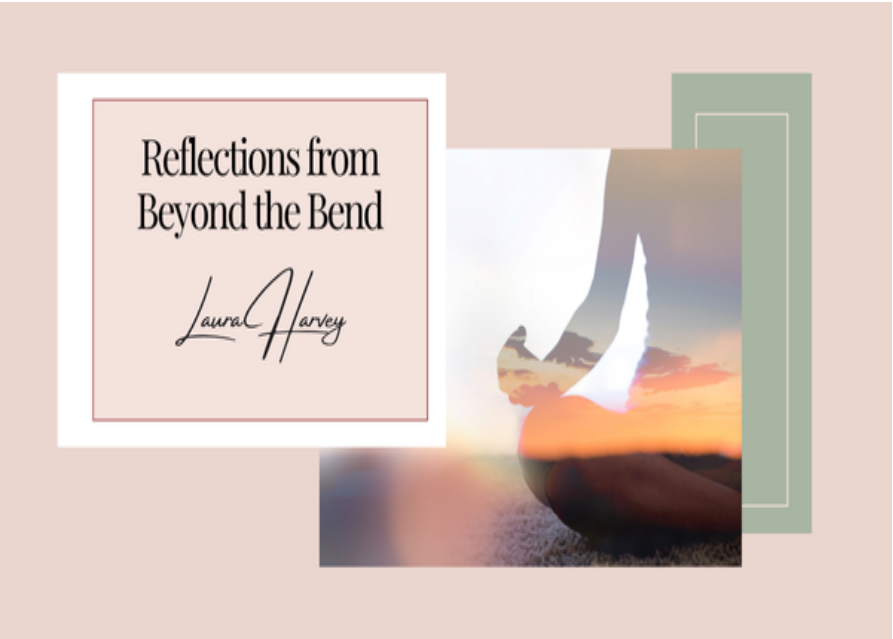
Laura Harvey <coachlharvey@gmail.com>

Coming home to your body

1 message

Beyond The Bend Yoga <laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca> Tue, Dec 16, 2025 at 12:47 AM
Reply-To: laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca
To: coachlharvey@gmail.com

BEYOND THE BEND YOGA



Hello Laura

Lately, I've come across a phrase that I've heard before but never really paused to understand.

Spiritual bypassing.

At first, it sounds… spiritual. Almost kind. Like something you'd want to do. But when I looked a little closer, I realized it names something many of us have done, often with the best of intentions.

It's when we use spiritual ideas to move around our human experience instead of through it. When we reach for gratitude to push away grief before we've even let ourselves acknowledge it's there. When we tell ourselves to "stay positive" so we don't have to feel what actually hurts. When we use spiritual concepts as a shield against our own humanity, rising above without ever letting ourselves land.

And this isn't about blame. It's about noticing. I'd love to explore this with you today.

With warmth and gratitude,
Laura 💗

This Week's Wellness Wisdom

The Body Knows Better

By Laura Harvey | Beyond the Bend Yoga

Most of us were taught, explicitly or subtly, that difficult emotions are something to transcend. That if we meditate enough, pray enough, practice enough, we'll somehow float above the messiness of being human.

But the body knows better.

The body doesn't bypass. It remembers. It holds. It waits patiently for us to listen.

We reach for "everything happens for a reason" to avoid feeling the devastation of what happened. We force ourselves into forgiveness to push away the anger that's still coursing through our nervous system. We tell ourselves that "spiritual people" don't feel rage or resentment, using that belief to suppress what's building in our jaw, our shoulders, our belly.

We use gratitude like a blanket to smother grief. We use positivity like a wall to block out pain. We use spiritual concepts to exile the parts of

ourselves we've been taught are too messy, too human, too much.

Here's what I've learned through years of somatic practice: You can't think your way past what your body is holding. And you can't spiritually transcend what you've refused to feel.

This is where somatic work offers something profoundly different. Rather than asking us to override our experience, it invites us to enter it safely. Rather than using spiritual ideas to push feelings away, we create space to finally let them be here. Rather than chasing transcendence, we practice the kind of presence that allows us to feel without being overwhelmed.

And something surprising happens there.

When we allow sensation, emotion, breath, and awareness to exist together without pushing anything away or forcing meaning onto it, there is often a quiet sense of wholeness that emerges. Not because we've fixed anything. But because we've stopped exiling parts of ourselves.

Your anger lives in your body. So does your grief, your joy, your exhaustion, your power. Spiritual bypassing uses spiritual ideas to push all of that away. Somatic practice creates the safety to finally let it in.

The women I work with are navigating profound transitions. Hormonal shifts that change how they feel in their own skin, identity changes that shake their sense of self, life stages that demand a new relationship with their bodies. This isn't the time to use spirituality to push your experience away. This is the time to come home to it.

When you breathe deeply and feel your body or feet on the ground, you're not just doing a relaxation technique. You're reconnecting mind, body, emotion, and spirit. You're telling your nervous system it's safe enough to stop pushing things away. You're accessing the wisdom your body has been holding all along.

In that way, this work isn't anti-spiritual at all. It's deeply spiritual. Because it reunites body, mind, and spirit, not by pushing the body's messages away, but by honoring them as part of the conversation.

Sometimes the most profound grounding comes not from rising above but from coming home.

A Gentle Gift Idea (For You, or Someone You Love)

This time of year, we are often asked, "What do you want for Christmas?"

And if you are like many of the women I speak to, the honest answer isn't "more things." It is simply quiet, space, and a moment to catch your breath.

If you are looking to give the gift of stillness, or if you would like to gently drop a hint to a partner or family member, **Beyond the Bend Yoga Gift Certificates are available.**

They can be used toward any of our upcoming **Winter 2026 Class Series.**

- **For the traditionalist:** I have beautiful, physical gift cards ready to be picked up or mailed. These are perfect to slip into a stocking or a card.
- **For the time-saver:** If you prefer, I can create a personalized digital certificate and email it directly to you (or your loved one) so it is ready instantly.

Simply reply to this email, let me know what you need, and I will take care of the rest.

Winter 2026 Session: Coming Home to Rising Moon

As we look toward the New Year, I am so looking forward to gathering with you again. Our Winter Session begins the week of January 12 and runs for 12 weeks through the end of March.

A warm reminder that all in-person classes, including our Wednesday morning group, will now be held at Rising Moon Studio in Sherwood Park. We will be settling into that beautiful space with the fireplace to keep us cozy through the winter months.

The Schedule

Mondays Somatic Vinyasa (6:00 to 7:15 PM)

Tuesdays Rise & Restore (10:00 to 11:15 AM) Restore & Reclaim (6:00 to 7:15 PM)

Wednesdays Morning Stillness (10:00 to 11:15 AM)

Registration is open. If you haven't saved your spot yet, you can do so

at the link below.

JANUARY CLASSES AT RISING MOON STUDIO

Join Us From Anywhere: Virtual Classes Now Open

For those of you who travel during the winter, or for the days when leaving the house simply feels like too much, I am happy to share that Virtual Class options are now open for registration.

This is a beautiful way to maintain your practice from your own living room (or your snowbird destination), staying connected to your breath and your community no matter where you are.

You can view the full virtual schedule and sign up here:

JANUARY LIVESTREAM CLASSES

A Note on the Holiday Pause

As our current session comes to a close this week, I want to thank you for practicing with me this autumn. We will be taking a pause from the schedule over the holidays.

Please remember that even though we aren't meeting on the mat, your breath is always there waiting for you.

OUR WEEKLY PRACTICE:

Allowing What Is

This week, instead of a written practice, I've recorded a short guided meditation for you.

You don't need an hour. You don't need a special space or the perfect conditions. Just a few quiet moments and somewhere you can be comfortable - sitting, lying down, however your body wants to rest.

This meditation is an invitation to practice what we've been exploring: presence without pushing anything away, listening to your body without needing to fix or transcend what you find there.

It's short, gentle, and designed to help you come home to yourself exactly as you are right now.

When you're ready, find your comfortable spot, press play, and let yourself arrive.

Listen to your meditation here

A Closing Thought

If you've ever felt like you were doing "all the right things" and still felt disconnected, heavy, or unsettled, there's nothing wrong with you. You may simply be ready for a different doorway.

One that doesn't rush you. One that doesn't demand positivity. One that welcomes the whole of you.

The spiritual path isn't about transcending your body. It's about finally trusting it enough to listen.

Your body knows what needs to be felt. Your nervous system knows what needs to be processed. The practice is creating enough safety to let that happen.

As always, take what resonates. Leave the rest. And trust that your body, wise, patient, and honest, knows the pace.

With warmth and gratitude,
Laura 💗

Our e-mail address is:
laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca

Want to change how you receive these emails?
You can unsubscribe from this list.